

Seawall height in Dania Beach

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

DANIA BEACH • BROWARD COUNTY

5.0

 ft NAVD88

New, substantially repaired or substantially rehabilitated seawalls in Dania Beach must reach at least 5.0 ft NAVD88. Permit applications filed before 1 Jan 2035 can be approved at 4.0 ft NAVD88 if the wall is designed to be raised to 5.0 ft by 2050. The city code sets no maximum seawall height.

The detail

MINIMUM	5.0 ft NAVD88 - Code Sec. 12-87(a)
INTERIM	Applications submitted before 1 Jan 2035 may be permitted at 4.0 ft NAVD88 if designed and constructed to accommodate 5.0 ft NAVD88 by 1 Jan 2050 - Sec. 12-87(a)
LDC CROSS-REFERENCE	same standard restated in LDC Sec. 240-30
APPLIES TO	new tidal flood barriers and substantial repair/rehab; not oceanfront seaward of the CCCL - Sec. 12-85
MAINTENANCE	walls must be kept in good repair; repairs due within 365 days of citation - Sec. 12-87(b)-(c)
WHOLE SHORELINE	substantial repair/rehab must cover the property's entire shoreline - Sec. 12-87(f)
ADOPTED	Ord. No. 2021-027, 26 Oct 2021 - Sec. 12-84 to 12-88
DOCK WORK COUNTS	The article also applies when fixed infrastructure such as a dock, davit or lift is attached to the barrier - Sec. 12-85
RIPRAP ON EVERY BARRIER	All tidal flood barriers, not only walls on new shorelines, must carry natural limerock riprap or approved habitat enhancement at the waterward face - Sec. 12-87(g)
FENCES AT THE WATER	Within 10 ft of the waterway, measured from the outer face of the seawall, no hedge, wall or opaque fence may stand more than 5 ft above the seawall; a see-through fence may go to 6 ft - LDC Sec. 235-30(B)

No higher than 3 ft above mean high tide, unless the yard is higher, in which case it may match the average ground level abutting the seawall - LDC Sec. 240-20(D)

Sale contracts for property in a tidally influenced area signed after 31 Dec 2020 must include a tidal flood barrier disclosure in at least 14-point capitalized bold type - Sec. 12-88

Where this comes from: Dania Beach Code of Ordinances Ch. 12, Art. XVII, Sec. 12-87 (Ord. No. 2021-027); LDC Sec. 240-30; Secs. 12-85 and 12-88; LDC Secs. 235-30, 240-20

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3 Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4 Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.